

Unit -5 People Skill for Professional Communication

5.1 Time management

Before learning time management it is necessary to know what time is. Time is course or flow which cannot be stopped. God has given 24 hours time to every creature on earth. Time cannot be exchanged or transferred. Time is unique. Time management is to divide our time in different segments. It is a kind of planning our work and it's time. By time management we limit our activity for specific time. People often say 'Time and tide wait for none' and 'Time is money'.

➤ How to manage Time?

- It is rightly said that 'Nobody plans to fail but fails to plan.' To manage time we need to plan our daily activity and make a table for it.
- Mostly we waste our time in decision making. So be positive and fasten your decision making process.
- Get up early in the morning as it is the only way to get a good time boost for the whole day.
- Every educational institute run smoothly just because of time management. For any primary help to make a time table check your school or college timetable.
- Select your work smartly on priority bases.
- Uniform is also a way to save time. Many celebrities follow uniform pattern for their work.
- For a big task delegate the responsibility to every group member.
- Don't give excessive time to any particular work or task.

Time management Matrix

	Urgent	Not Urgent
I M P O R T A N T	Quadrant – 1 > DO • Medical urgency • Work Deadline • Accidental problems	Quadrant – 2 > Decide • Self Empowerment • Fitness • Going out with family • Planning • Relationship building
NOT I M P O R T A N T	Quadrant – 3 > Delegate • Helping others in their priority work • Pickup someone from the railway station or airport • Take a call while working	Quadrant – 4 > Delete • Watching TV • Gossiping • Using mobile phone • Hang-up in social media

➤ Benefits of Time management

- Time is a limited recourse. So its best use can help us to improve productivity.
- If everything is well planned, we can feel relaxed. Doctors also advice time management for stress relief.
- A habit of time management helps us in grabbing more opportunity.
- Time management will lead us to work perfection.
- It can lead us to successful professional life.
- It helps in separating personal and professional life.

5.2 Stress Management

What is stress?

Researchers define stress as a physical, mental, or emotional response to events that causes bodily or mental tension. Simply put, stress is any outside force or event that has an effect on our body or mind.

Stress can come from any situation or thought that makes you feel frustrated, angry, or anxious. Everyone sees situations differently and has different coping skills. For this reason, no two people will respond exactly the same way to a given situation.

Stress is a normal part of life. In small quantities, stress is good; it can motivate you and help you become more productive. However, too much stress, or a strong response to stress can be harmful.

Adrenaline is a chemical naturally produced in our body as a response to stress .

Sources of Stress

- The Environment – the environment can bombard you with intense and competing demands to adjust.
- Examples of environmental stressors include weather, noise, crowding, pollution, traffic, unsafe and substandard housing, and crime.
- Social Stressors – we can experience multiple stressors arising from the demands of the different social roles we occupy, such as parent, spouse, caregiver, and employee.
- Examples of social stressors include deadlines, financial problems, job interviews, presentations, disagreements, demands for your time and attention, loss of a loved one, divorce, and co-parenting.
- Physiological – Situations and circumstances affecting our body can be experienced as physiological stressors.
- Examples of physiological stressors include rapid changes on hormones, illness, aging, accidents, lack of exercise, poor nutrition, and sleep disturbances.

Strategies of Stress management

1. Don't compare
2. Change perceptions
3. Take a break
4. Set reasonable/realistic goals
5. Avoid procrastination
6. Don't compromise your values/beliefs
7. Be organized and plan your things
8. Examine your diet
9. Take enough sleep
10. Do normal exercise regularly
11. Practice pranayam
12. Discuss your problems with friends and family
13. Follow a good hobby
14. Live with an Attitude of Gratitude Be Grateful for what you have.

5.3 Respecting Privacy

Privacy refers to how much physical and mental space we desire from others and how much of the same they desire from us. While it is good to have a professional bonding much for a team to gel together, it is also equally important to maintain a reasonable distance with our colleagues in work environment.

Majorly privacy is divided into two parts: **personal privacy and organizational privacy**.

There are two dimensions of personal privacy:

- Personal space – refers to the physical distance you should maintain with a colleague, in terms of where you sit or stand, your gestures and what you can and cannot do.
- Informational privacy – refers to what you can or cannot say

Organizational Privacy: it is about safeguarding the relevant company information.

Why are Privacy issues important?

- Western influences on professionalism which emphasis on clear separation of one's private life from professional one. Thus, maintaining clear physical distance from the colleagues.
- Globalization: it has exposed us to prevailing norms and sensibilities regarding privacy in other cultures thus, one has to follow it, learn, respect and be sensitive to them for doing business with those cultures.
- Now there are definite legal implications for non – compliance of privacy laws and therefore, legal aspects of privacy has come into focus with maturation of e – business and after the telecom revolution.
- It makes good business sense to follow the international etiquette on privacy issues with global partners.

- Thus, respecting privacy has been considered as a soft skill and respecting means considering the specific sensitivity to the other person and not just the general awareness.

Requirements of privacy:

- To offer comfort zone to the other person
- To create non – threatening atmosphere in the office for business transactions
- To recruit people who are very careful regarding their own personal data as well as about their organization's private and proprietary information.

Physical Space: There's a greater sensitivity to physical space in USA than in India.

- Americans, by and large, stand farther from you when they talk to you.
- A lot of Europeans shake hands with their colleagues almost everyday, whereas with Americans it is a remote 'hello' or 'hi'; handshake is reserved only when you first meet someone or when you them after long gap or while congratulating.
- In restaurants American tend to sit far from other guests and almost never share a table with strangers while in India, it isn't uncommon to find people sharing the tables.
- Even in crowded places, people tend to protect their private space.
- While it is common in India to find four people sharing three seats or six people squeezing into a compact car, you will never find this in America.
- When Americans go to a restaurant, they usually 'go Dutch' in the sense each person pays for himself. In India, it is very common that 'someone takes you for a treat.'
- An Indian does not mind an occasional back slap or doesn't think too much of putting his hand over his colleague's shoulder, but people from some other cultures like American may not appreciate such a gesture.
- Even while driving, Americans maintain a 'space' around their car.

Suggestions on how to avoid violating personal space of others:

- Maintaining physical distance – maintain a distance of at least an arm's length with your colleagues and no unnecessary physical contact.
- Respecting your colleague's office space – the space behind the desk is his personal space, never cross over that side of the table.
- Not borrowing or requesting to share your colleague's personal belongings – no borrowing of their vehicle or not using the phone on his table without his permission.
- Not using his computer – now a days computers are truly personal and no one would like someone else to peep through them.
- Not visiting his home unless invited specifically.

Informational Privacy

When a large amount of personal data circulating in the cyberspace and open to attacks from lurking predators, you need to know enough about cyber – security and how to protect everyone's confidential

data from such attacks. Certain topics which aren't to be discussed with your colleagues or foreign counterparts are as under:

- Date of birth, age
- Marital status, romantic life, children and family and sexual orientation
- Salary, property, jewellery, financial transactions and stock market activities
- Phone numbers and addresses
- Health condition of family members
- Religious orientation
- Educational qualifications, resumes
- Marks, grades, annual performance review details
- Reasons for their absence of work yesterday
- Itinerary, plans and schedules
- Political orientation and views
- Don't volunteer unsolicited help

How to live in privacy based Workplace

- Get over the misconception that there is nothing wrong about getting other people's personal information
- Use the correct way of building profiles on people at work
- Let the topics evolve naturally, don't force them
- Leave the other person(s) alone if that is their wish
- Never assault other person's sound space
- Be careful about your personal information

Organizational Privacy and Proprietary Information

It is not necessary all the information of the organization is known to every employee of the organization, thus if you are privy to it, it should be not assumed it is know by everyone. Thus, this information shouldn't be passed on to your colleagues isn't to be passed to your colleagues as certain information is only for those who need to know. And there are many parties who are interested in knowing the information of your organization for example; competitors etc.

Points to be kept in mind for following organizational privacy:

- Don't discuss business details with family members
- Don't spread information about company decisions, project status etc.
- Don't discuss company's future plans
- View customer data as sacred
- Protect your company's intellectual properties
- Guard privileged information

5.4 Learning to Say 'No'

Yes and No are two small words but it requires thinking to say any. For an acceptable work we can say yes immediately but how about a difficult or a not acceptable task? We often hesitate to say no because as social beings, we have to preserve our relationships. In such cases we forcefully say yes to some unwanted or uncomfortable tasks. But sometimes it is better to say 'No' in order to save the relationship or for a positive result.

Mind well that **Saying No Doesn't Mean You're a Bad Person**. While saying no we are afraid that every time I did this, I would disappoint someone, make them angry, hurt their feelings, or appear unkind or rude. So, how to say No? It becomes a decisive question many a times. We don't have to say 'No' bluntly, but we have to learn the way to say no. If we will bring the sentiments in between it would be difficult to handle the situation. What are the easiest ways to say 'No' comfortably?

➤ Don't Give Explanation

Offering an excuse may seem like the polite way to decline a request but it sets you up for an awkward situation. The problem with offering an excuse is it gives people the opportunity to change their request so that your excuse doesn't justify your 'no'.

Here are some examples:

- You decline someone's invitation to go out for coffee because you already have plans on the day they requested...then they ask you what day works best for you.
- You tell someone you can't go to a party because you have no one to watch the kids...they offer to let you bring your kids.
- You apologize for not being able to help someone with a project because you're working towards a major deadline...they reply that they'd love to have your help once you're finished with your current project.

No matter what excuse you offer, people who are determined to get you to say yes can come up with a way to invalidate it. By simply thanking people for their request and telling them that you can't agree to it, you prevent them from arguing with you.

➤ Give an Alternative

If the person asking you for something is someone who you want to maintain a positive relationship with, you can lessen the impact of your no by offering an alternative that satisfies their want while being something that is more preferable to you.

For example:

- If someone wants you to collaborate with them on a project, introduce them to someone else who might be interested.
- Your new friend invites you to a bar but loud places and drinking isn't your thing. Ask them if they want to grab coffee or do another activity instead.

- An eager young employee in your office offers to help you with an important project but you fear their involvement would slow down progress. Ask them if they want to work with you on a lower pressure project instead.

The goal is to offer compromise so they don't take offense to you saying no and you don't feel guilty for turning down a request that would add unneeded stress to your life.

It is all about Knowing Your Value. The second step to learning to say no is realizing that you are valuable and choosing your own opinion about yourself over others. I have learned that if you live your life depending on other people's approval, you will never feel free and truly happy. In this condition you are basically saying is "Their opinion of me is more important than my opinion about myself." You are unique, valuable, and important. No one else in this world can offer what you can. You will realize that it really isn't worth to say yes when you want to say No.

➤ **Helpful Tips for Saying No**

- Politely say "No, I can't" or "Sorry, I don't want to."
- Don't apologize for saying No or don't give all reasons for it.
- Don't tell a lie. Lying will most likely lead to guilt. We don't want to cheat any one that's why we say no.
- Remember that it is better to say no now than crossing the deadlines and not doing anything.
- Be polite, such as "Thanks for asking."
- Practice saying no. Imagine a scenario and then practice saying no either by yourself or with a friend. This will get you feeling a lot more comfortable with saying no.
- Don't say "I'll think about it" if you don't want to do it. This will just prolong the situation and make you feel even more stressed.

5.5 Team Building

Teamwork is an essential part of workplace success. Like a basketball team working together to set up the perfect shot, every team member has a specific role to play in accomplishing tasks on the job. Although it may seem as if one player scored the basket, that basket was made possible by many people's planning, coordination, and cooperation to get that player the ball. Employers look for people who not only know how to work well with others, but who understand that not every player on the team can or will be the one who gets the ball. When everyone in the workplace works together to accomplish goals, everyone achieves more.

Importance of Team building

Team building is a key part of corporate culture. Team building helps people see each other in a different light and connect outside of their usual work setting. Team bonding provides a great way for everyone to connect and find a greater sense of common ground within and outside the organization.

1. Facilitates Socialization and Networking for the Greater Good
2. Boosts Team Performance
3. Promotes Adaptability and Reduces Stress
4. Increases Team Spirit and Fun
5. Sparks Innovation and Creativity

6. Builds Trust Among Team Members
7. Cultivates a Positive Company Culture
8. Strengthens Problem-Solving Skills
9. Demonstrates Employee Appreciation
10. Bridges Gaps Between Departments
11. Unlocks Leadership Potential
12. Connects Teams Across All Levels
13. Enhances Employee Engagement and Morale
14. Increases Retention and Job Satisfaction
15. Makes Conflict Resolution Easier

5. 6 SWOT analysis

SWOT stands for:

Strengths: advantages unique to the organization or offering

Weaknesses: disadvantages unique to the organization or offering

Opportunities: potentially helpful strategies or practices available to the organization or the offering

Threats: competitors or risk factors that could impact the organization's or offering's success

A SWOT analysis is a realistic, fact-based, data-driven review of an organization. It helps define a company's competitive position, assesses internal and external issues, and evaluates its current and future potential. A SWOT analysis is a strategic planning technique that a **business** can use to examine its standing in four key areas. It evaluates information from all sources that may have uncontrollable impacts on a company's decisions.

- **Strengths:** Strengths describe what an organization excels at and what separates it from the competition: a strong brand, loyal customer base, a strong balance sheet, unique technology, and so on. For example, a hedge fund may have developed a proprietary trading strategy that returns market-beating results. It must then decide how to use those results to attract new investors.
- **Weaknesses:** Weaknesses stop an organization from performing at its optimum level. These are areas where the business needs to improve to remain competitive: a weak brand, higher-than-average turnover, high levels of debt, an inadequate supply chain, or lack of capital.
- **Opportunities:** Opportunities are favorable external factors that could give an organization a competitive advantage. For example, if a country cuts tariffs, a car manufacturer can export its cars into a new market, increasing sales and market share.
- **Threats:** Threats refer to factors that can potentially harm an organization. For example, a drought is a threat to a wheat-producing company, as it may destroy or reduce the crop yield. Other common threats include things like rising costs for materials, increasing competition, tight labor supply, and so on.

Creative and Critical thinking

What is Critical Thinking?

Critical thinking is a skill to take proper decisions during any emergency situation. It is a logical and step by step process. In this process we think, analyze, evaluate and interpret information. In the result of this process we take a right or proper decision. We use critical thinking to make a logical decision after a sequence of thoughts. It is useful in our day to day life for various purpose like; to solve problem, for a judgment, to find solution, to defend our thought etc. in short it is



Problem



Thinking



Solution

Critical thinking skill helps one in a successful decision making. To take a stand on any issue we need open mindedness, reasoning ability and mental calmness. Here is a list of some skills which can help in critical thinking; reasoning, analyzing, comparing, classifying, surmising, anticipating etc.

What is Creative Thinking

Creativity is the ability to see thing differently. In modern times sometimes it is also called out of box thinking. Not to be creative is impossible. There is a great demand of creativity in every profession. People welcome creativity and innovation. In professional language these types of people are also known as entrepreneurs. Creativity requires imagination power, positive thinking, observation skill, experimental ability, willingness, daring to tap the opportunity etc.

1. Creativity is to dream different and to do it differently.
2. It is related to generating ideas and makes it a reality.
3. The first phase of being creative starts from a brainstorming.
4. It has no connection with coping other's idea.
5. It is an attitude of continuous improvement.

6. It is about finding other possible ways to do a same thing.
7. Fear of failure and comparison are common creativity killer.
8. To generate idea we have to adopt and respect others idea as well.
9. Creativity has a close relation with flexibility.
10. Creativity gives us fearlessness in our professional life.

4 Quotients

Physical Quotient: PQ relates to our physical health, fitness, and body awareness. It encompasses:

- Physical fitness and endurance
- Nutrition and diet
- Sleep quality
- Stress management
- Body-mind connection

Intelligence Quotient: IQ measures a person's level of comprehension. IQ represents our cognitive abilities and logical reasoning skills. It includes:

- Problem-solving capabilities
- Abstract thinking
- Pattern recognition
- Memory and information processing

Emotional Quotient: EQ refers to our ability to recognize, understand, and manage our own emotions, as well as those of others. Key components include:

- Self-awareness
- Self-regulation
- Empathy
- Social skills
- Motivation

Spiritual Quotient: SQ represents our capacity for meaning, purpose, and transcendence. It involves:

- Self-awareness at a deeper level
- Ability to find meaning and purpose in life
- Capacity for compassion and empathy
- Holistic thinking and seeing interconnections
- Ability to face and transcend suffering